ATTENSION

Generative firmware for Bastl Instruments Kastle 2



Home is where the fox lives.

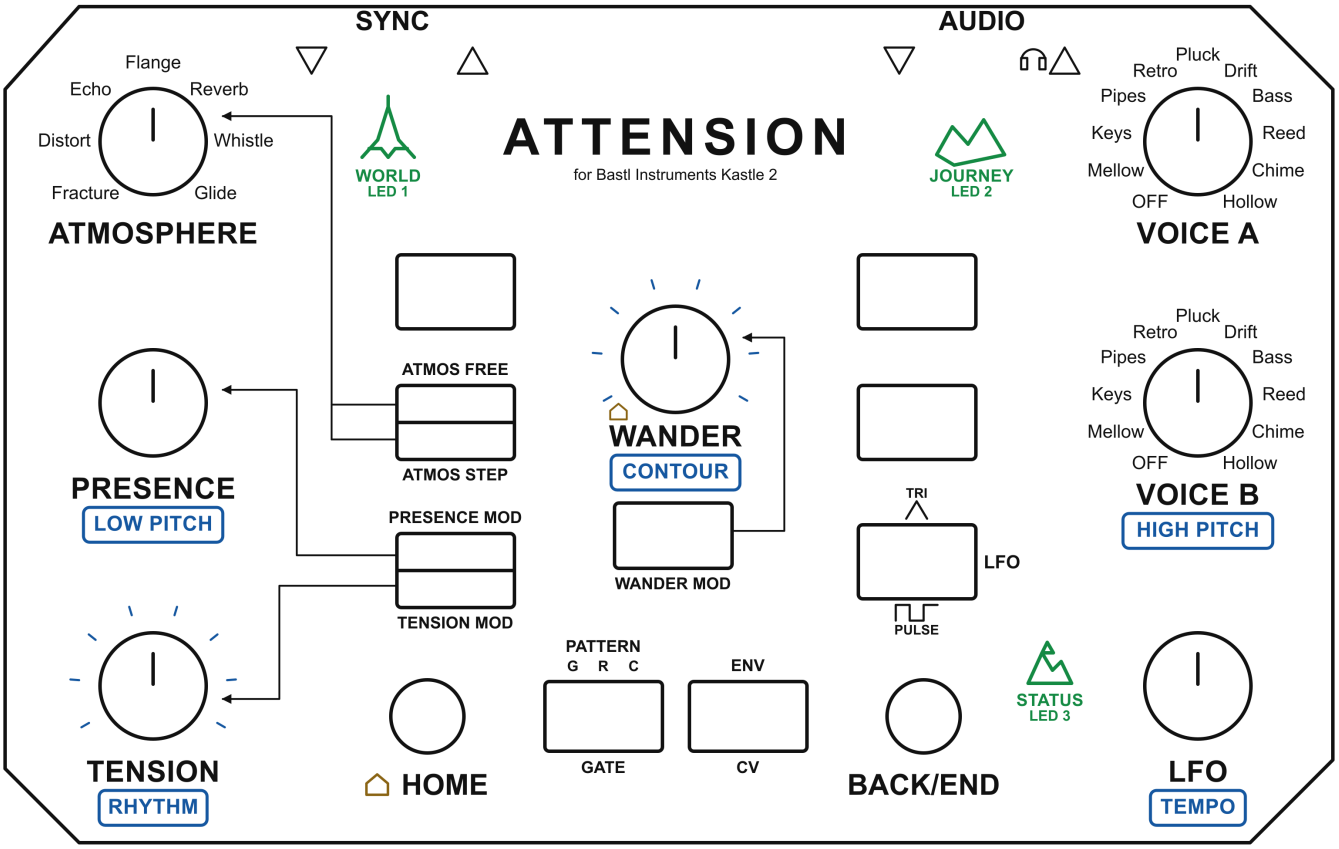
User Manual

ATTENSION is generative musical firmware for the Bastl Instruments Kastle 2. It turns the Kastle into a small musical collaborator, built around a simple idea: a fox leaves *Home*, wanders through an evolving musical world, and eventually finds its way back. The fox is the music; *Home* is its familiar melody. You guide the fox with a handful of controls while **ATTENSION** handles the details–melody, harmony, rhythm, variation and surprise.

You don't have to know where the fox is going. That's the point. You decide how adventurous the journey should be, and **ATTENSION** discovers what happens along the way.

Start anywhere

On power-up, **ATTENSION** creates a new semi-random *Home* melody from its **Low Pitch**, **High Pitch**, **Rhythm**, and **Contour** settings. *Home* stays with you for this session unless you choose to create your own; next time you power up, **ATTENSION** creates a fresh one.



No sound? Make sure **Voice A** isn't turned **OFF** (fully counter-clockwise). To adjust the **volume**, hold **HOME** and turn **Voice A**. **Voice B** may intentionally rest or hold as part of the journey; that's normal.

Different Kastle 2? FX Wizard, Alchemist, and Wave Bard have different faceplates, but their physical controls are the same. Just follow the diagram above regardless of your Kastle 2 version.

The ATTENSION journey

Home is where the fox lives–the musical centre of every journey. It is **ATTENSION**'s central melody. **Wander** changes how far the music departs from that melody, or where the music goes. **Atmosphere** changes what the world around it sounds like, **Presence** controls how strongly that **Atmosphere** is applied, and **Tension** changes how eventful and unsettled the journey becomes.

Wander decides how far the fox travels from *Home*. Musically, turning it clockwise doesn't select a different song or world; it progressively transforms the *Home* melody. Close to *Home*, the melody remains recognizable. Farther away, its notes, rhythm, shape, and register can change more dramatically.

Atmosphere changes the world the fox travels through, or what the journey sounds like. Turn it through **Fracture**, **Distort**, **Echo**, **Flange**, **Reverb**, **Whistle**, and **Glide**. Positions between two effects blend them together.

Presence controls how much the **Atmosphere** affects the fox. Turn it down for a subtler effect. Fully counter-clockwise removes **Atmosphere** and leaves the original voices unchanged (or "dry").

Tension makes the journey more active and dramatic. As **Tension** increases, **Voice B** participates more often, harmonies can sound less resolved–creating more expectation before they settle again–and drums become more likely to add fills and flourishes. At the midpoint, **Voice B** becomes a consistent harmonic partner; at the highest settings, it increasingly follows **Voice A**.

Voice A and **Voice B** choose the sounds that play the music. You can use either voice by itself or both together. **Voice A** carries the main melody. **Voice B** is a companion voice controlled by **ATTENSION**; it may join **Voice A**, rest for a while, follow it, or hold a note against it. Turn either voice knob clockwise through **OFF**, **Mellow**, **Keys**, **Pipes**, **Retro**, **Pluck**, **Drift**, **Bass**, **Reed**, **Chime**, and **Hollow**.

As the fox wanders, **ATTENSION** will occasionally bring back the original *Home* melody as a familiar refrain, then continue the journey. **ATTENSION** chooses when this happens; you don't need to trigger it. Think of it as the music remembering *Home* before setting out again.

Time to return *Home*? Turn **Wander** fully counter-clockwise to the *Home* icon. **ATTENSION** will finish its current phrase before making its way back.

Follow the lights

World (LED 1, Top Left): Colour follows **Atmosphere**; brightness follows **Presence**.

Journey (LED 2, Top Right): Colour follows **Wander**, traveling from violet at *Home* through the spectrum to red at the farthest clockwise setting. Brightness follows **Tension**.

Status (LED 3, Bottom Right): Green while previewing a new *Home*, and a cyan tempo pulse while the **HOME** button is held.

Break it down

Hold **HOME** to call the fox back *Home* without losing the journey. Release **HOME** and **ATTENSION** picks up where it left off.

Ready to finish? Press **BACK/END** at any time and **ATTENSION** will bring the journey *Home* and create an ending for you. When the song has finished, press **BACK/END** again to begin a new journey with the same *Home* refrain.

Make *Home* your own

Hold **HOME** and press **BACK/END** to enter Preview. Now you can build the melody that the fox calls *Home*, one piece at a time:

Control	What you hear
Low Pitch (Presence)	Choose the lowest note of *Home*.
High Pitch (Voice B)	Choose the highest note of *Home*.
Rhythm (Tension)	Choose how the notes of *Home* are spaced and played.
Contour (Wander)	Choose how the melody travels between your low and high notes.

This is the suggested order, but you can adjust and revisit any of these controls as you build your *Home*.

Rhythm selects between eight different rhythmic families, while **Contour** shapes pitch movement within the Low/High range. A soft "tok" marks each setting as you turn either control. Within a **Rhythm** setting, give the knob a small nudge to hear another variation of the same family. Keep exploring until you find a *Home* you like.

Happy with it? Press **HOME** to make it your new *Home* melody and begin the song from there. Press **BACK/END** instead to cancel and leave your old *Home* untouched. Your new *Home* stays with you for this session. Power **ATTENSION** off and it will create a fresh *Home* the next time it starts.

Useful combinations

Gesture	Function
HOME + **Atmosphere**	Adjust **Audio In** level.
HOME + **Voice A**	Adjust the volume.
HOME + **LFO / Tempo***	Set the song tempo.

***Without **HOME**, **LFO / Tempo** controls the speed of the **TRI** and **PULSE** modulation outputs.

Patch and explore

This is where **ATTENSION** gets especially playful. A changing patch signal can take over a modulation destination around the physical knob's setting. Want control back? Move the knob. When the patch signal stops changing or is disconnected, **ATTENSION** returns control to the knob.

ATTENSION destination	What it does
Atmos Free	Moves **Atmosphere** continuously around the knob's current position.
Atmos Step	Samples **Atmosphere** and holds each change for a phrase.
Presence Mod	Moves **Presence** around its current position.
Tension Mod	Changes **Tension** phrase by phrase.
Wander Mod	Moves **Wander** through all 13 steps between *Home* and the farthest destination.

Four good places to start

Source	Try it
TRI	Smooth, sweeping movement. Turn **LFO / Tempo** to change its speed.
PULSE	Sharp jumps between two levels. Turn **LFO / Tempo** to change its speed.
Gate	Rhythmic on/off movement driven by the sequencer.
CV	Stepped movement that changes along with the sequence.

Now cross the wires. Try **TRI** → **Atmos Free** for a slowly shifting world, **PULSE** → **Presence Mod** for a more dramatic push and pull, or **CV** → **Wander Mod** to let the sequence influence how far the fox roams. Then ignore these suggestions and patch something else!

Bring something else along

Connect an external sound source to **Audio In** and mix it alongside **ATTENSION.** Hold **HOME** and turn **Atmosphere** to adjust its level.

Sync it up

Connect an external source to **Sync In** and **ATTENSION** will get its beat from it.

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